



The Women's Courtyard Plus

The Women's Courtyard

Founded in 2003, The Women's Courtyard is a multicultural, community-based nonprofit dedicated to supporting adolescent girls and young women facing situations of risk and trauma. Through a holistic and compassionate approach, the organization helps participants build stability, resilience, and pathways toward independent and meaningful lives. The Courtyard provides a safe and welcoming environment where young women can access essential support, including nutritious meals, clothing, emotional guidance, educational and employment assistance, and advocacy for their rights. Working in partnership with the National Insurance Institute, the Ministry of Welfare, local municipalities, and philanthropic supporters, the organization creates opportunities for long-term social and personal integration.

The Women's Courtyard is seeking philanthropic support to expand its therapeutic and community-based services, with a particular focus on growing the **Women's Courtyard Plus** initiative. Developed in response to the ongoing impact of the "Iron Swords" war, the program addresses the sharp rise in anxiety, depression, trauma, and instability experienced by vulnerable young women. For many already living on the margins of society, the crisis has intensified existing hardships, leading to a significant increase in referrals from welfare departments and emergency services. Young women are arriving after losing housing, employment, or family support systems. Many are coping with violence, severe isolation, or untreated trauma, often without access to consistent mental health care. In response, Women's Courtyard Plus was created as an innovative and holistic model of support in Haifa's Hadar diverse and difficult neighborhood.

Building on more than two decades of experience serving approximately 200 young women annually, the initiative expands the trusted Women's Courtyard model by integrating professional mental health services directly within a warm, community-centered environment. A dedicated clinical floor, located within the same welcoming open space, enables the young women to access psychological and psychiatric care in a setting that feels safe, familiar, and nonjudgmental.

This unique and innovative approach helps young women move from crisis and survival toward healing and long-term stability by making professional mental health care accessible in a safe, normative and familiar environment.

Population served Young women aged 18–26 from marginalized and underserved Jewish and Arab communities in Haifa and in northern district. Participants often experience overlapping challenges, including trauma, poverty, neglect, abuse, social exclusion, and barriers associated with immigrant status. The courtyard plus Program aims to serve 50 young women at its first stage and, be expanded and replicated.



Results are monitored, and evaluated by the “Tovnot” Research Institute to ensure accurate, real-time measurement of outcomes, including persistence in care, mental well-being and trauma recovery, reduction of high-risk behaviors, and functional and social integration. Early findings already show that participants report feeling heard, gaining greater control over their behavior, and developing a more positive sense of self, their abilities, and their achievements. Many also describe a renewed sense of hope for the future, as they move from survival mode toward actively making plans for their lives.

For these young women, therapy, is not a luxury, it is life-saving.

Funding Need

- Annual cost of Women’s Courtyard Plus: **230,000\$**
- Government and municipal funding secured: **130,000\$**
- Philanthropic support needed: **\$100,000**

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